BuildLinka

Features by profile and how the app works

Covers the four profiles: Vendor, Worker, Engineer and Buyer, plus the shared screens. Written for review of the app as it is in the code today (Expo SDK 57, version 1.0.0, 1 October 2026, branch *modernize-screens*).

Important: the app is still a **working design prototype**. Every screen opens and most buttons now do something, but all names, products, orders, earnings and projects are sample data built into the app. Nothing is sent to a server, nothing is saved after the app closes, and no real money moves. The calculators use real formulas, and the camera, barcode scanner and GPS are real. Section 7 lists exactly what is real and what is demo; section 8 lists what is still broken.

1. How the app works (the journey)

1. **Welcome slides.** On first open the user sees swipeable intro slides and can tap *Skip* or *Get Started*.
2. **"Who are you?"** The user chooses Vendor, Worker, Engineer or Buyer and taps *Continue*, or goes straight to the main app.
3. **Profile dashboard.** Each profile opens its own dashboard with its own tools (sections 2 to 5).
4. **Main app (5 tabs):** Home, Materials, Cart, Workers (titled "Professionals") and Profile, shared by everyone.

Shared tabs and screens

Screen	What the user can do
Home	Location bar, notifications bell, greeting, a search bar with **Scan** and **Photo** shortcuts, promo card, material categories (8 shown, tap to see all 12), featured banners, today's best deals, popular vendors, workers near you.
Search (new)	Opens from Home. Live results while typing, grouped into categories, materials (with quick add to cart) and professionals. Recent searches, popular searches and a category grid. **Barcode / QR scanner** with flashlight: a match opens the product. **Search by photo**: take or pick a photo (matching needs a server, see section 7). "See all" opens Materials with the search filled in.
Materials	Search, **Category** and **Sort** dropdowns, "In stock" toggle, Clear, grid or list view. In grid view the Add button turns into a quantity stepper once an item is in the cart.
Cart	Items added from any product page or calculator, quantities, order summary, go to checkout.
Workers ("Professionals")	Search by name, skill or area. **Trade** dropdown with counts, **Sort** dropdown (Recommended, Top rated, Lowest rate, Most jobs, Most experienced), "Available now" and "Near me" (GPS asked only when tapped). Tapping a worker opens a profile sheet with skills and stats and a hire request with number of days and estimated cost.
Profile	User card and stats, referral card, recent activity, orders, listings, reviews, settings, logout.

Material category screens (all 11 rebuilt)

Every category screen now has a green header banner, a **calculator built on standard building formulas**, buying tips, the products in that category, a vendor card and a "hire" banner that opens Professionals. Where a matching product exists, the calculator result can be added to the cart in one tap.

Category	Calculator	Add result to cart
Cement	Slab (1:2:4 or 1:1.5:3), screed or plaster → bags of cement, tonnes of sand and granite. Brand comparison with "Lowest price".	Yes
Steel & Iron	Bar size guide (8 to 25 mm). Rebar for slab mesh, columns and beams, or a plain weight check → rods, kg and binding wire.	Yes (12 mm rod)
Roofing	Roof type, shape, pitch, overhang and waste → sheets, true roof area, ridge caps, screws. Comparison of roof types.	Yes (aluminium)
Blocks	Wall length and height minus doors and windows → number of blocks.	Yes (9 inch)
Tiles	Floor or wall, tile size, straight or diagonal → m² to order, tile count, adhesive bags.	Yes (60 × 60)
Paint	Room size, doors, windows, coats, ceiling, number of rooms → litres, 20 L buckets or 4 L tins.	Yes (emulsion)
Plumbing	Pipe run → number of pipe lengths and fittings. Water tank size for a household.	Yes (pipes)
Electrical	Appliance list → total load, inverter/generator size, main cable size, battery for backup hours.	No product yet
Glass	Pane size, count and thickness → area and weight, with safety-glass warnings.	No product yet
Timber	Timber list in market sizes (2×4, 2×6, 1×12…) → pieces and cubic metres.	No product yet
Equipment	Rental planner: day rate vs week rate → cheapest way to book and money saved.	No product yet

Each product has a detail page with photos, vendor, rating, price, delivery, quantity selector, reviews, shipping information and "You may also like".

2. Vendor profile

Who: shops and suppliers who sell building materials. **Goal:** list products, manage stock and track sales.

Vendor dashboard

- Store header with the store name, notifications bell and an **Open / Closed** switch for the shop.
- Key numbers: **Total sales**, **Orders**, **Profile views**, **Rating**.
- **Critical stock alerts** for products running low, each with a *Restock* button.
- **Sales trend** chart, **recent orders** with status (Pending, Shipped, Delivered), and quick actions: Add listing, Inventory (My Store), Analytics, Settings.

Vendor tools

Screen	Features
Add Listing (rebuilt)	One scrolling page instead of four steps. Photos from camera or gallery (up to 6, asks permission first, tap a photo to make it the cover). Title with character count, category chips, description. Price in ₦ with automatic commas, unit chips (bag, piece, sheet…), stock quantity stepper. "You receive per unit" after the 10% service fee. A progress bar and a "3 left" counter; the Publish button stays above the keyboard and lists what is missing.
My Store (rebuilt)	Listings / Inventory toggle with a red badge for low stock. Stat cards, search, filter chips with counts. Listings: Publish (drafts), Mark sold, Delete. Inventory: In stock / Low stock / Out of stock pills, stock bar, quantity stepper, Restock sheet with quick +10 / +25 / +50 / +100, Add-to-stock sheet with category chips, product list and live margin.
Settings (vendor section)	Opens with a **Store** section only for vendors: "Accepting orders" switch, My Store, Sales & Analytics, "Low-stock alerts" switch.
Saved Locations (rebuilt)	Real GPS: shows "You are here" with street and area; the user **names the place** and picks a type (Home, Work, Site, Other) before saving. Shows distance to each saved place, Directions in Google or Apple Maps, edit / rename, delete, and "Add address manually" with a "Use my current location" button.
My Inventory, Sales Analytics, Orders	Unchanged: stock list and value; sales by month and week, best sellers, busiest times; orders with status filters.

How it works for a vendor

1. Choose *Vendor* on the "Who are you?" screen.
2. Tap *Add listing*, add photos, details, price and stock, then *Publish listing*.
3. Buyers find the product through Home, Search, Materials or a category calculator, and order it.
4. The vendor watches orders and stock alerts, restocks in My Store, and pauses the shop in Settings when needed.

3. Worker profile

Who: masons, electricians, plumbers, painters, tilers, carpenters and other trades. **Goal:** get hired, manage jobs and track earnings.

Worker dashboard

- Profile header with name, trade and **daily rate**, and an **availability switch**.
- Overview numbers, skills, **earnings** (this week, this month, last month) and **upcoming jobs**.
- Quick actions: Create work, **Find jobs** (now opens straight on the Jobs list), Profile, Reviews, Team, Settings.

Worker tools

Screen	Features
Create Work (rebuilt)	One scrolling page. Trade chips, skill chips (several allowed, count shown), daily rate in ₦ with commas, phone number (checked for at least 10 digits), work area, short "about" text with counter, availability switch. The keyboard "next" key moves between fields and the Publish bar stays above the keyboard. **The keyboard no longer covers the form**.
Find Jobs / Nearby (rebuilt)	Workers / Jobs toggle with counts, search, **Trade** and **Sort** dropdowns. Job cards show distance, "Urgent", duration, budget and an **Apply** button that turns into "Applied" (tap again to withdraw). Worker cards have a working **Hire** button.
Edit Profile, My Reviews	Photo, name, email, phone, location, bio; reviews and ratings from clients.

How it works for a worker

1. Choose *Worker* and open the dashboard.
2. Tap *Create work* to publish trade, skills and daily rate.
3. Keep availability on; buyers find the worker in Professionals or Find Nearby.
4. Use *Find jobs* to filter by trade and apply for nearby jobs.

4. Engineer profile (rebuilt)

Who: registered engineers who supervise building projects. **Goal:** oversee projects, budgets, teams, site visits and technical documents. All engineer screens now share the same data, so a change on one screen shows on the others while the app is open.

Engineer dashboard

- Profile card with name, title, location, rating and a **COREN** pill; notifications bell with unread count.
- **Live numbers** worked out from the data: active projects, % of budget spent, specs waiting for review, site visits this week.
- **Needs attention**: projects at risk, delayed, or spending faster than they progress (for example "Spent 85% of budget at 60% progress").
- **Upcoming site visits**: tick to mark done, or + *Schedule* (project, purpose, day and time).
- Active projects and quick actions: New project, Team, Specs, Settings.

Engineer tools

Screen	Features
My Projects	Total budget, spent and project count; search; **status dropdown** (On track, At risk, Delayed, Completed) with counts; New project (name, client, location, budget, deadline).
Project detail (new)	Change status; update progress with −10 / −5 / +5 / +10 (asks to complete at 100%); budget card with **Log expense** and an overspending warning; site visits (schedule, tick, remove); crew (assign people, call them); the project's specifications with + *Add*.
Specifications	Search, status filter, project filter. Detail sheet with approval steps: **Submit for review** → **Approve** or **Send back to draft**, and **Reopen**. Add a new spec as a draft.
Team	Totals (on site, idle, unassigned), search, status filter. **Call, Text and Email** buttons open the phone apps. Sheet to change status and assigned project.

5. Buyer profile

Who: home owners, developers and contractors. **Goal:** buy materials, hire workers and plan building projects.

Buyer dashboard

- Welcome header with notifications bell and cart button with item count; summary numbers.
- **Shop by category** is now a dropdown: pick a category to open its page and calculator (the "Steel & Iron" link was broken and is fixed).
- Recommended products, recent orders and quick actions: Build, Cart, Hire, Orders.

Buyer tools

Screen	Features
Build Project	Project planner with templates (3-bedroom bungalow, duplex, shop/office): basics, timeline and budget level, cost breakdown, materials and workers needed, payment plan, and an "AI Building Assistant" chat (scripted, see section 7).
Calculators	The 11 category calculators (section 1) turn sizes into quantities and add them to the cart.
Checkout (rebuilt)	One page: items with "Edit cart"; delivery method cards (Standard, Express, **Pickup station** which hides the address); address with **"Use my current location"**; phone; payment method (Card, Bank transfer, Paystack) with what happens next; totals. Missing fields turn red. Success screen with order number, delivery time and "Track my order". An empty cart shows a message instead of a checkout. **Typing no longer closes the keyboard after each letter.**
Hire workers	Professionals tab hire sheet (days and cost), and the Workers marketplace hire form (start date, days, description, total).
Orders / History	Current orders with status; history filtered by All, Delivered, Cancelled, Returned.
Saved	Wishlist products and saved locations (real GPS, see section 2).

How it works for a buyer

1. Choose *Buyer* (or skip and use the main tabs).
2. Find materials with Search, Scan, Materials or a category; use the calculator to get the right quantity.
3. Add to cart and check out with delivery or pickup.
4. Hire a worker from Professionals, then follow orders from the dashboard.

6. Other screens (all users)

Screen	Features
Notifications	Alerts with unread count shown on every dashboard bell.
Settings (rebuilt)	Profile card with Edit; Account (saved locations, privacy & security, hide profile); Preferences (notifications, language); Support (help center, contact, about). **Log out** now asks to confirm. Version number read from the app. Hidden admin entry: triple-tap the version text at the bottom, then a 4-digit PIN.
Admin Panel	Platform overview, user lists, push notification composer, featured banners, reports, export, settings.
Delivery Dashboard	Logistics screen with deliveries and alerts. Still built but not linked from anywhere.
Help Center / Privacy	Help topics and privacy & security options.

7. What is real and what is demo today

Area	Status today
Screens, navigation, layout	**Working.** All screens open; Android keyboard handling fixed app-wide.
Camera, gallery, GPS	**Working.** Real permissions; GPS address used in Saved Locations, Checkout and "Near me".
Barcode / QR scanner	**Working.** Reads real barcodes. Only the 8 sample products have barcodes (listed in the second document).
Calculators	**Working.** Standard formulas, checked by automatic tests. Some inputs are typical figures (sheet coverage, paint spread, appliance watts) and must be confirmed with professionals.
Search by photo	**Needs a server.** The app takes the photo and is ready to send it, but no matching server exists yet; the user is asked to pick a category instead.
Cart, saved items, engineer data, applied jobs	**Works while the app is open.** Lost when the app closes.
Products, vendors, workers, orders, projects, earnings	**Sample data** written in the app code.
Login / accounts	**Not built.**
Chosen profile (role)	**Not saved.** Asked every time the app starts.
Payments	**Demo only.** Placing an order clears the cart and shows an order number made on the phone.
AI Building Assistant	**Scripted replies.** Not connected to a real AI.
Listings, work listings, hire requests, applications, placed orders	**Demo only.** A success message shows, but the item does not appear in My Store, Professionals or Orders.

8. Problems still open (checked in the code on 1 October 2026)

#	Problem	Where
1	Worker dashboard "View all" opens */my-jobs*, which does not exist.	worker-dashboard.tsx, line 208
2	Delivery dashboard is built but no button opens it.	delivery-dashboard.tsx
3	After leaving a dashboard there is no way back to it from the main tabs or Profile.	Profile tab
4	Admin PIN is fixed as "1234" inside the app.	settings.tsx, line 10
5	Buttons that still do nothing: Home (vendor and worker cards, worker "Hire", promo card); Profile (settings icon, Share, Log Out); Product (vendor badge, wishlist heart); Popular Vendors (Visit Store, Call); Order History (Reorder); Orders and My Reviews cards; My Inventory edit and restock.	index.tsx, profile.tsx, product/[id].tsx, popular-vendors.tsx, order-history.tsx, orders.tsx, my-reviews.tsx, my-inventory.tsx
6	What a tester creates does not show up elsewhere: a placed order is not in Orders, a new listing is not in My Store, a work listing is not in Professionals.	checkout, add-listing, create-work
7	The old search bar component still has a filter button that does nothing (used by the Workers marketplace).	components/SearchBar.tsx
8	Status bar colour after leaving a green category header needs checking on a real phone.	components/CategoryShell.tsx

Fixed since the 30 September review

- Nearby *Hire* and *Apply* buttons now work; Find Jobs opens on the Jobs list from the worker dashboard.
- Upgraded to Expo SDK 57 (fixes the known memory problem in the JavaScript engine).
- Keyboard covering forms on Android, and Checkout closing the keyboard after every letter.
- Search box losing text on Materials and Professionals; "Near me" always showing nobody; trade filters missing "Master Mason" and similar.
- Wrong calculators: cement (about 3 times too few bags), roofing (ignored slope and overhang), plus invented plumbing and electrical formulas.
- Fake "bulk deals" with "View deal" buttons that did nothing were removed from all category screens.
- Category screens without a back button; broken "Steel & Iron" category link; Settings "Log out" doing nothing.

Suggestions for fixing these, a **test plan to run before building the backend**, and the steps to a real launch are in the second document, **"BuildLinka - Suggestions for Real-World Launch"**.